

1. The 146 credits — what it actually means

Research date: 17 August 2026. Everything below was checked against official sources on that date.

The short answer

Your 146 credits are almost certainly a bookkeeping quirk, not a missing year of study. We are about 85–90% confident of this.

This matters enormously, because it was the single thing that could have closed off most of Europe. It very probably does not.

But there is one thing **you personally have to confirm** before anyone can rely on this. It is explained in "What you need to check this week", below. Please do that first — everything else in this research rests on it.

Why we think the 146 is not a real shortfall

Tunisian law says your degree is 180 credits

The Tunisian *licence* is defined by law — Décret n° 2008-3123 of 22 September 2008, Article 5 — as:

*"three years after the baccalauréat, comprising **180 credits spread over six semesters**"*

This was confirmed again in Décret Présidentiel n° 2022-631 of 14 July 2022.

So 180 credits is a **legal property of the qualification itself**. It is not something a particular transcript can reduce. If you hold the licence, you hold a 180-credit degree, whatever any individual document happens to total.

And Tunisian rules produce transcripts that under-count on purpose

This is the part that explains your specific number.

Under Article 34, a module (*unité d'enseignement*) is "**capitalised**" only if you score 10/20 or above in it. But Article 35 lets you pass the year by **compensation** — if your weighted average across all modules is 10/20 or better, you progress, even with some modules below 10.

So a student who graduates perfectly legitimately by compensation ends up with modules that were **validated but never "capitalised"**. If your transcript prints the "*crédits capitalisés*" column, every compensated module is silently left out.

Now check the arithmetic:

- $180 - 146 = \mathbf{34 \text{ credits missing}}$
- Tunisian modules are worth **4 to 7 credits each** (Article 22)
- $34 \div (4 \text{ to } 7) = \mathbf{\text{roughly } 5 \text{ to } 8 \text{ modules}}$

Five to eight modules passed by compensation, across three years, for a student averaging 12–13/20, is completely ordinary. This explains your exact number better than any other theory.

European evaluators judge the degree, not the transcript sum

The bodies that assess foreign qualifications do not re-add your transcript line by line. They ask a simpler question: *is this qualification, in its own country, equivalent to our bachelor's, and does it let you into a master's at home?*

Sweden's national agency (UHR) is the clearest example we found. It states plainly that both the *Licence Fondamentale* and the *Licence Appliquée* are **three years, 180 credits, equal to a Swedish**

bachelor's degree (180 ECTS).

Norway's agency states the principle even more directly:

"one year of standard study time in the country of education is equivalent to one year (60 ECTS) in Norway."

Six of the seven recognition bodies we checked place the Tunisian licence at bachelor level.

The other possibilities, honestly weighed

We did not just look for the convenient answer. Here is the full ranking:

What might be going on	How likely	What it would mean
Compensation artefact — transcript shows only "capitalised" credits	~50%	No problem. Your degree is 180 credits.
Incomplete or interim transcript — missing the final semester, or the PFE credited separately	~30%	No problem, once you get the complete document.
Local reporting quirk — modules weighted so semester totals aren't exactly 30	~15%	No problem, but needs explaining to admissions.
A genuine shortfall	~5%	Serious — but this is only possible if you have not actually graduated.

That last row is the one to be candid about. If you hold the *diplôme national de licence*, a shortfall is impossible by definition, because 180 credits come with the award. The only scenario where 146 is a real number is one where the degree was never conferred.

We are not assuming that away. You need to confirm it.

What you need to check this week

Take out your paperwork and answer these seven questions. This costs nothing and settles the entire issue.

1. **Which document are you looking at?** A *relevé de notes* (a marks sheet, provisional), an *attestation de réussite* (pass certificate), or the *diplôme national de licence* itself? Only the last two prove the degree was awarded.
2. **Does it cover six semesters (S1–S6)?** Count them. If it stops at S5, it is incomplete by construction.
3. **Is your PFE / final-year project listed and credited?** Your CRM platform project should be carrying credits.
4. **What does the credits column actually say?** "Crédits", or "Crédits capitalisés" / "Crédits acquis" / "Crédits obtenus"? **If it says capitalisés or acquis, the mystery is solved right there** — that is theory 1 confirmed on the face of the document.
5. **Are there modules marked below 10/20 where the year is still marked *validé* or *admis par compensation*?** If yes, theory 1 is confirmed.
6. **Add up the credits assigned to each module in the *plan d'études*** — the official programme structure, ignoring your marks. If that totals 180, then the programme is 180 credits and your 146 is pure bookkeeping.
7. **Is it a *Licence Fondamentale* or a *Licence Appliquée*?** It is printed on the diploma. **This one matters a great deal** — see the Netherlands section below.

The cheapest fix in this entire report

Before spending a dinar on formal evaluations, do this:

Ask FSEG Sousse for a written attestation, on faculty letterhead, stating that your Licence comprises 180 credits over six semesters and three years, and that it gives access to Mastère study in Tunisia.

Also request the **supplément au diplôme** (Diploma Supplement). Tunisia issues these, following the standard European model, and it describes the level, content and status of your studies in a format European admissions officers already recognise.

These two documents are **free, take days, and neutralise the 180-credit objection almost everywhere**. They are worth more than any country choice you could make.

Why this works: the risk you actually face is not that Europe has judged your degree insufficient. It is that a busy admissions officer reads "146" off a raw transcript and rejects you before a qualified evaluator ever sees the file. That is a **presentation problem**, and a one-paragraph letter from your faculty defuses it.

If you later need a formal evaluation

You probably will not need one. Only buy it if a specific programme demands it.

Body	Country	Cost	Time
ENIC-NARIC France	France	€20 + €100 = €120	4 months average, up to 6
ZAB	Germany	~€208	~2–3 months
UK ENIC	UK	£49.50 + VAT (~£59)	~15 working days
UHR	Sweden	Free	Not confirmed
Denmark's agency	Denmark	Free, and legally binding on universities	1–2 months
CIMEA	Italy	NOT VERIFIED – check directly at cimea.it	NOT VERIFIED

Two warnings about the French one, which we verified directly on the France Éducation International site (their own page, checked 17 August 2026):

- It takes **four months on average and up to six**. If you need it for an autumn 2027 intake, you must apply by **late 2026 or very early 2027**. This cannot be rushed.
- It covers **one qualification per file**. Do not order several speculatively.

Denmark's assessment is free *and binding on Danish universities*, which makes it unusually good value if Denmark is in play.

Which countries are actually open to you

Based on how each country handles this question — not on programme quality, which comes later.

Open — the credit question is unlikely to block you

Country	Why
United Kingdom	Does not use ECTS at all. Judges you on the degree and its classification. The constraint simply does not exist here.

Country	Why
France	Thinks in terms of " Bac+3 " — three years past the baccalauréat, a <i>duration</i> , not a credit count. Tunisia's system descends directly from the French one. The most natural fit you have.
Spain	Law asks for "3 complete academic years", and there is a route to master's access without full degree homologation.
Italy	Asks for "at least three years", assessed at degree level through CIMEA.
Poland	Applies the Lisbon Convention access principle — if the degree gives access to a master's in Tunisia, it gives access in Poland.
Norway	States the year-equivalence rule explicitly. This dissolves the problem outright.

Conditional — admissible, but needs a specific documented step

Ireland, Belgium, Denmark, Sweden, Austria, Czechia, Portugal, Finland, Luxembourg.

These are all reachable. Each needs either a recognition certificate, a documented equivalence, or a conversation with the admissions office. Belgium writes 180 ECTS into its access rules, so the FSEG attestation matters most there — and Belgium is otherwise one of your strongest options, being French-speaking.

Difficult or closed

Country	Problem
Germany	Enforces six semesters AND 180 ECTS . But the credits are probably <i>not</i> your main obstacle here — your GPA is . German universities commonly want a 2.5 or "good" grade, and 12–13/20 likely falls short. Deprioritise, but see the Germany research for exceptions.
Switzerland	Explicit rule: "at least 3 years, at least 180 ECTS", applied strictly, and the applied-sciences institutions add a work-experience requirement on top. Practically closed.
Netherlands	A different and worse problem — see below.

The Netherlands — a separate problem, and why your diploma wording decides it

This is the one case where fixing the 146 changes nothing at all.

The Dutch evaluation body, **Nuffic**, does not rate the Tunisian licence as a full bachelor's. It publishes two different verdicts depending on which licence you hold:

Your diploma says	Nuffic rates it as	What that means
Licence Appliquée	3 years of HBO	Fine. Dutch applied-sciences master's are open to you.
Licence Fondamentale	2 years of WO	A problem. That is a full year <i>below</i> a Dutch bachelor's.

If yours is *Fondamentale*, Dutch research-university master's are structurally very hard, and a "pre-master's" cannot rescue it — those are capped at 60 credits, which cannot bridge a full year.

It gets worse: we found that **Utrecht does not allow pre-master's students who need a residence permit**, and **the University of Amsterdam cannot sponsor a permit for a standalone pre-master's**. So even the bridging route is often closed to someone in your position.

This is why question 7 on the checklist matters. Go and read your diploma.

But do not conclude that one licence is simply "better"

After writing the above we managed to query **anabin**, Germany's official recognition database, directly. Germany's verdict is the **exact reverse** of the Dutch one:

Your diploma says	Netherlands (Nuffic)	Germany (anabin)
Licence Fondamentale	2 years of WO — a problem	"Entspricht" — <i>equivalent</i> to a German 3-year Bachelor
Licence Appliquée	3 years of HBO — fine	"Bedingt vergleichbar" — <i>conditionally</i> comparable

anabin also confirms **Université de Sousse is rated H+**, a recognised state institution.

So whichever licence you hold is an advantage somewhere and a disadvantage somewhere else. There is no bad answer to question 7 — there is only a different map depending on the answer. What matters is knowing which one you have before you choose countries.

(This is moot for Germany in practice — see deliverable 2, where the grade and the German-language requirement block you regardless of how your credential is rated.)

Three things that are commonly believed and are wrong

We checked these because they are repeated everywhere, and they would have sent you down bad paths:

1. **"Universities of applied sciences are always more flexible."** Not true in Germany (Fachhochschulen apply the same 180 rule, often 210), not true in Finland (their applied universities demand **two years of work experience**, which research universities do not — you have an internship, so this likely rules you out), and not true in Switzerland.
2. **"A Studienkolleg can bridge the gap in Germany."** No. Studienkolleg is for **bachelor's** entry only. It is irrelevant to your situation.
3. **"Germany, the Netherlands and the Nordics are all strict."** Too crude. **Norway explicitly assesses by years** and is one of your most open countries on this question. Denmark gives a free, binding assessment. The Netherlands is strict — but for an entirely different reason than credits.

What we could not verify

Being straight with you about the gaps:

- **The German anabin database entry** for Université de Sousse. anabin is an interactive database that does not render for automated checking. Someone needs to look it up manually at anabin.kmk.org if Germany stays in play.
- **UK ENIC's specific published line on Tunisia** — their detailed comparisons sit behind a subscription. The general position is bachelor-level, and comparable Moroccan qualifications are assessed at bachelor level, but the Tunisia-specific statement is NOT VERIFIED.
- **CIMEA's fee and turnaround** for Italy — NOT VERIFIED — check directly at cimea.it.
- **FSEG Sousse's own programme credit tables** — the faculty site (fsegso.rnu.tn) returned an error on the day we checked. You can get this yourself from the *scolarité*, and you should.
- **Whether a formal 1:1 legal decree exists** converting Tunisian credits to ECTS. In practice they are treated 1:1 (Sweden maps "180 national credits" straight to "180 ECTS"), but we found no decree stating it. This does not affect the conclusion.

What to do first

1. **Read your diploma** — *Fondamentale* or *Appliquée*? (Decides the Netherlands.)
2. **Work through the seven-question checklist** on your transcript.

3. **Email FSEG Sousse scolarité** and request the attestation (180 credits / 6 semesters / access to Mastère) and the *supplément au diplôme*. Free, and worth more than anything else here.
4. **Do not buy a credential evaluation yet.** Wait until a specific programme asks for one.

Once you have confirmed you graduated and hold the diploma, treat the 146 as a non-issue and choose your programmes on their merits.